

ONLINE INFORMATION HANDLING PROTOCOL

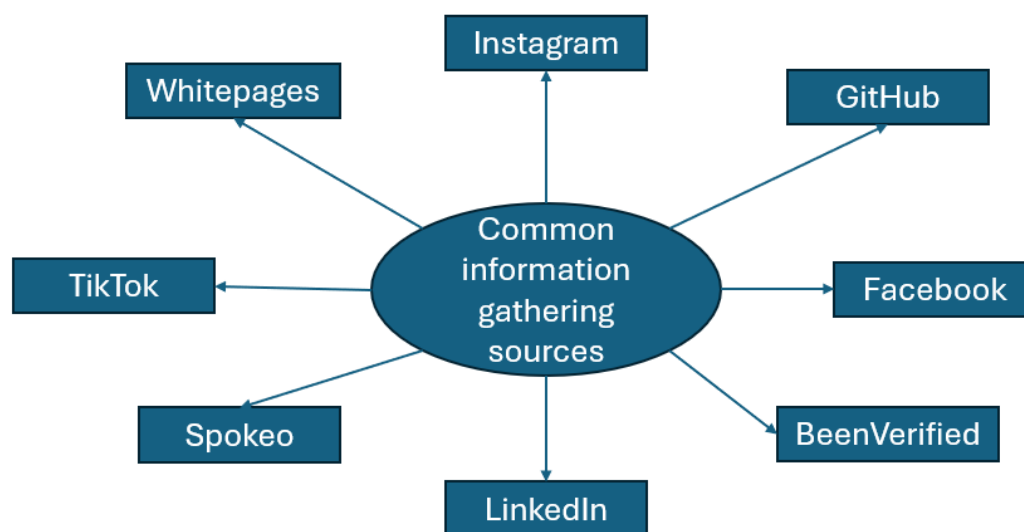
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Introduction

This online information handling protocol is designed in aiding users to have more control over their data and maintain tighter OPSEC. This protocol was developed because currently attackers can compromise data brokers, use social media or people searching sites to perform spear-phishing attacks. Some common sources attackers use to find information are TikTok, Instagram, Spokeo, LinkedIn and Facebook. These are commonly used to the amount of data available either from users themselves or data collected over time by data brokers like Spokeo.

This protocol cannot provide perfect OPSEC or get rid of all personal information stored by data brokers. However, this protocol can tighten OPSEC and allow you to have more control over your data. This protocol can be used by anyone but its mainly for those with threat models such as competitors, organised cybercriminals, hacktivists, nation-state. Make sure to adapt this protocol based on your own security needs and threat model. You may look at my security architecture, other frameworks or do your own research if this protocol can't be adapted to your needs.



The spider diagram above shows the common sources that an attacker gathers information from. This diagram doesn't show all sources of information they may use. As for example, nation-state actors may have access to government records and logs directly from providers. Make sure to do specific research based on your threat model.

Main Online information Handling Protocol Section

This section is the main protocol for controlling your personal data and maintaining OPSEC. This section isn't specifically for nation-state actors as more research will be required for nation-state level protections and OPSEC. This protocol can be adapted to your specific model and own security resources.

- The first step is to calm down as always
- This can be done by taking some deep breathes or releasing anger in a non-harmful way
- This step is important to reduce any emotional noise and allow you to focus more
- The second step is creating or using a database
- This means having a securely stored database that tracks which providers currently have access to your data
- This could be done using the structure what (The provider) → Type (What kind of data do they have?) → Security (How secure is your data in this provider?) → Impact (What could happen if that provider were to be breached?).
- This step does not mean that you need to track every single entity that has your data. That is impossible and only the most sensitive providers should be logged
- If you already have created a database, you can use this as cross-reference in the searching step
- The third step is searching
- This step means searching for personal information about yourself online
- This information can include full name, age, address and DOB.
- Searching for this information can be done through search engines, AI models, reviewing your own social media and free tiers of people searching sites.
- Do be warned that using certain AI models and search engines can be a privacy risk. Make sure to use privacy tools as needed.
- The fourth step is the removal
- This step means removing that personal information about yourself online
- This can be done by removing personal information shown on social media accounts and opting out of people searching sites.
- The removal process should be documented inside of the database you made in the second step of this protocol.
- You should also make sure to verify that the removal was successful by reusing the searching step.
- This protocol should be repeated depending on your threat model.
- For example, for the average user it may be a every 1-2 months